

GNU Project

Richard Stallman initiated the GNU Project in 1984 with the aim of developing a sufficient body of free software by involving a team of volunteers around the world.

Open source licence

An open source licence is a copyright licence for computer software that allows users to modify and redistribute the original source code without having to seek permission from the original author

Touched by tech

interactive artworks! You can do all this, even if you don't know a bit of Flash and coding. All you need to do is visit this site: <http://scratch.mit.edu>. Scratch has a set of innovative tools through which people without any computer programming skills, and that means a vast majority of us, can create animations. Just download the free software from the site and get started. With its comprehensible menu based system, Scratch is eminently easy to use. You can either upload images from your own computer or you can use the ones that already exist in the Scratch library.

FastStone

www.faststone.org/index.htm

The advent of the digital age has surely made it easy for us to go on an image-capturing spree. So how many of these

which can be read on your PC, notebook, iPad, iPhone or any other portable device. Project Gutenberg could easily have made money by showing advertisements to users who access it for downloading free books. However, it continues to be a non-profit organization, which survives on donations. You can donate via your Paypal account or by sending a check or money order to the website's registered address in USA.

Internet Archive

www.archive.org/index.php

Ah nostalgia! Reminiscing the good old days is such an enjoyable way of passing time. How about reminiscing the websites, as they were two years or even a decade ago! What did Google look like 10 years ago, a period of time when the Internet was still in its Stone Age era?

Only Internet Archive has the answer.

The mission of the Internet Archive is to back up the entire Internet. As of now, it has more than 3 petabytes of information in its servers, that's 85 billion Web pages. A mind-boggling number, you have to agree! This website too relies on donations. You can donate through your credit card or through Paypal.

Kiva

www.kiva.org

This is one of those websites, which are dedicated to letting you pick up the role of a Good Samaritan. Out here you can do some micro lending of your own and contribute to the cause of alleviating poverty. There are so many people around the world who are in need of sums as small as \$25; Kiva introduces you to them. As of now the website claims to

have a default rate of less than 3%. In 97% of the cases, the lenders got their money back. Kiva is a charity and not a broker, so you don't get any interest on the money you have lent; what you do get is the feeling of having done something to help a fellow human being. Till November 2009, Kiva has facilitated loans of more than \$100 million.

MoodTurn

www.moodturn.com

When you are totally stressed about one thing or other, a tryst with MoodTurn might go a long way in helping you calm down. This is a website that promises to turn your mood by playing soothing music, which conjures visions of sublime nature, while visuals of a natural scene are playing on the screen. Developed by a 24-year-old Ramunas Geciauskas, who happens to be a computer programmer based in Lithuania, MoodTurn has already become a source of succour to thousands of stressed out employees. Once you have imbibed the soothing visuals and sounds, don't forget to reward the efforts of Ramunas Geciauskas, the man behind MoodTurn, by making a donation.

Craigslist

www.craigslist.org

The classifieds out here are divided into different categories. So if you are looking for a job in Bangalore, then you go to the Bangalore section of the website and there you have to browse through the jobs category. Much of the service that you get out here is free of cost, and the website is not averse to receiving donations from users. So if you have had a success through a Craigslist post, then you might go ahead and donate a small amount as a gesture of thanks.

Zwaggle

www.zwaggle.com

The truth is that most of us own items, which might not be of much use to us anymore. However, we have no idea how to donate these items to people who might be in need. That is where websites like Zwaggle comes in. Out here you can log in and find ways of giving away your superfluous items to the needy denizens of the world. **d**



images are of really good quality! You may not be able to shoot like a pro, but there are other ways by which you can enhance the quality of your pictures. For instance, there is the software called FastStone, which does just about everything you would expect from an image viewer. You can crop, resize, fix red-eye, adjust image tone and do much else. All this is available for free. However, if you wish, you can donate any sum that you can afford to spare.

Free Websites

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www.gutenberg.org

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